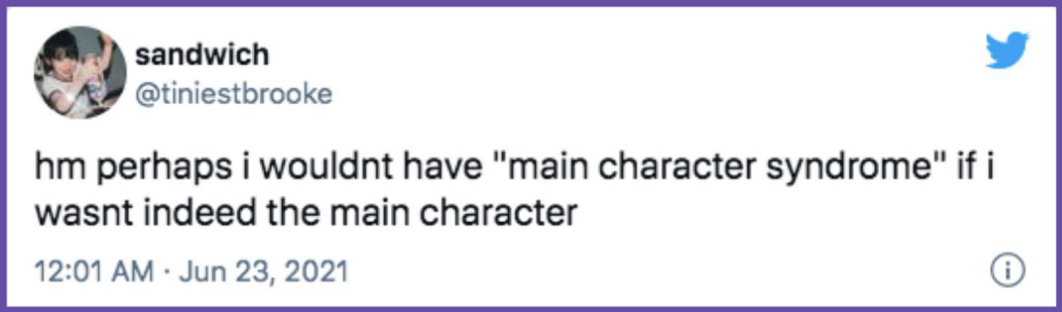
MW 11-12:15PM I Healy 105

ENGL141 Sec.02

Topics in 19c British Literature



CLASS DESCRIPTION

Main character syndrome: self-empowerment or narcissism? Can everyone have a soundtrack to their daily life, or is that only for some? This survey of Victorian literature will explore the power dynamics that permit some characters to become the focal point and some to fade into obscurity – both in their individual texts and in popular culture as a whole. To do so, we will explore characters that have "stood the test of time" as well as characters that, while famous to Victorians, have not translated to twenty-first century American audiences. Our objective is to discover whether there is a "universal" main character energy, and, more importantly, if we really want to aspire to inhabit that role in our own lives.

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

LINDSEY E. R. O'NEIL

Office Hours by appointment (In person or Zoom)

Think of my office hours as an extension of the classroom. I am happy to discuss any aspect of your writing or reading, as well as any questions you may have about class procedures or requirements. You may "stop in" my [Zoom] office whenever you like. I ask that you give me at least 15 min to figure out where my laptop and Zoom login is when scheduling.

CLASS POLICIES

ATTENDANCE & PARTICIPATION: This class is primarily discussion based. You will be expected to come prepared to discuss the day's assigned text**. THIS MEANS YOU SHOULD BE CONTRIBUTING SUBSTANTIALLY TO DISCUSSION IN EACH CLASS PERIOD.** You are also required to bring the assigned text to class on the day it is to be discussed. If you miss class for any reason, it will be your responsibility to find out what you missed and how you can make up the work from another student. More information on Georgetown's Attendance/Absence Policy can be found online.

LATE WORK: Assignments are due on the date and time designated on the course syllabus. That deadline holds true whether you can make it to class or not; technological issues are NOT an excuse for late papers. Late papers will be marked down one-half letter grade per day late, including weekends. If you must submit a late paper, you should contact me the day the paper is due.

PAPER FORMAT: Unless otherwise indicated, the standard format is:

- double-spaced throughout (with no extra spaces between paragraphs)
- Arial/Times New Roman/Calibri (12 point, no italics except for titles or emphasis)
- one-inch margins on all sides, left justified
- your name, my name, the section number for the course
- title of the paper center justified
- numbered pages

When you cite information, you should follow MLA style guidelines.

TECHNOLOGY: You may use a laptop or tablet for PDFs posted on Canvas. If these technologies become a distraction, I reserve the right to revoke this privilege. The first disruption will result in a warning; the second time your phone disrupts class, you will bring cookies in for the entire class the next class meeting. Lack of attention due to technology will also be factored into your participation grade.

COURSE CONTENT NOTE: Due to the nature of this course, we will be discussing historical events and texts that may be disturbing, even traumatizing, to some students. If you ever feel the need to step outside during one of these discussions, either for a short time or for the rest of the class session, you may always do so without academic penalty (You will, however, be responsible for any material you miss. If you do leave the room for a significant time, please make arrangements to get notes from another student.)

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY: Plagiarism, whether it is submitting someone else's work as your own (including AI), submitting your own work completed for another class, or otherwise violating the University's code of Academic Integrity, will not be tolerated. Please contact me if you are uncertain of the definition of these academic violations and their potential consequences.

ACCESSIBILITY

Your success in the class is important to me. If there are circumstances that may affect your performance in this class, please let me know as soon as possible so that we can work together to develop strategies for adapting assignments to meet both your needs and the requirements of the course. If your name or pronouns need to be corrected, please let me know. If you have questions or concerns regarding physical, digital, or course accessibility, you may also contact arc@georgetown.edu or visit https://academicsupport.georgetown.edu/disability/.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week 1 Introductions & Foundations
W Jan 7 Syllabus Day (feat. painful ice breakers).

Week 2 Definitions
M Jan 12 Frow, "Type" (2014); Brilmyer, Intro to *The Science of Character* (2022)
W Jan 14 Selections from Shelley, "A Defense of Poetry" (1821) & "Ozymandias" (1818); Carlyle, *On Heroes, Hero-Worship, and the Heroic in History* (1841)

Week 3 Shelley
M Jan 19 MLK Day
W Jan 21 *Frankenstein* (1818) Preface, Letters, Ch 1-10

Week 4 Shelley
M Jan 26 *Frankenstein* (1818) Ch 11-16
W Jan 28 *Frankenstein* (1818) Ch 17-End
Reflective Project I Due Sunday, February 1st, at 11:59PM.

Week 5 Dramatic Monologue I
M Feb 2 Browning, "My Last Duchess" and "Porphyria's Lover" (1842)
W Feb 4 Tennyson, "Ulysses" (1842); Arnold, "Dover Beach" (1867)

Week 6 Autobiography
M Feb 9 Seacole, *Wonderful Adventures of Mrs. Seacole in Many Lands* (1857)
W Feb 11 Seacole, *Wonderful Adventures of Mrs. Seacole in Many Lands* (1857); "A Tale of Two Nurses" *Empire* [podcast] (2023)

Week 7 Braddon
T Feb 17 Seacole, *Wonderful Adventures of Mrs. Seacole in Many Lands* (1857); Pinto, "'The Right Woman in the Right Place': Mary Seacole and Corrective Histories of Empire" (2019)
W Feb 18 *Lady Audley's Secret* (1862) Vol 1, Ch 1-7

Week 8 Braddon
M Feb 23 Vol 1, Ch 8-14
W Feb 25 Vol 1, Ch 15-19 (End Vol 1)

Week 9 Spring Break!

Week 10 Braddon
M March 9 Vol 2, Ch 1-9/Ch. 20-28
W March 11 Vol 2, Ch 10-13/Ch. 29-31 (End Vol 2)

ASSIGNMENTS

PARTICIPATION:
35% of Final Grade.
Active and repeated participation in class and group work. This includes bringing in questions, observations, passages that confused you, and so on. Texts and drafts should be brought on the days they are assigned.

REFLECTIVE PROJECTS (3):
35% of Final Grade.
These projects can take the form of: a literary close reading/traditional academic paper or an unessay project. In-depth explanations of the types of projects can be found on Canvas. I am also open to discussing other options; bring all ideas to me! Increasing length as the semester progresses.

CO-LEADING DISCUSSION (3):
10% each/30% total
At the beginning of the semester, you will sign up in groups of 3-4 for 3 dates to lead discussion. By 12am on your discussion date, you will post on our class GoogleDoc 1) a one-paragraph summary of the reading or an annotated section of the reading <u>and</u> 2) at least 3 questions for class debate and discussion.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week 11 Braddon
M March 16 Vol 3, Ch 1-6 /Ch. 32-37
W March 18 Vol 3, Ch 7-10/Ch. 38-41 (End)

Reflective Project II due Sunday, March 22nd, 11:59pm

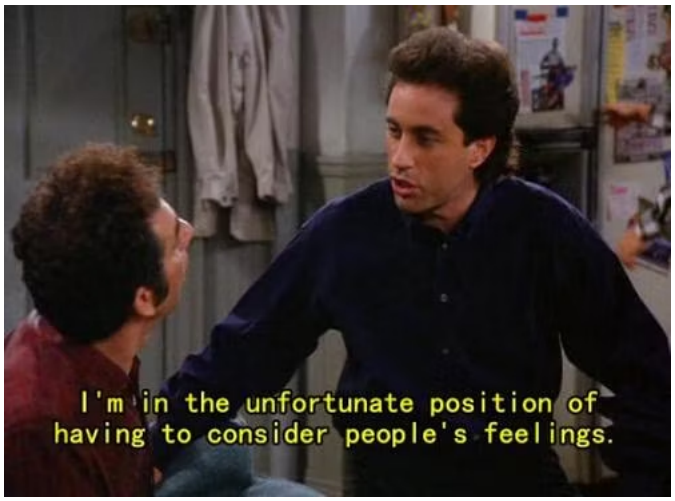
Week 12 Dramatic Monologue II
M March 23 Webster, "A Castaway" & "The Happiest Girl in the World" (1870)
W March 25 Tekahionwake/Johnson, "A Cry from an Indian Wife" (1885) & "A Strong Race Opinion" (1892)

Week 13 Easter
M March 30 Hopkins, "The Windhover," "As Kingfishers Catch Fire," "Pied Beauty"
W April 1 Asynchronous Class for Easter/Family Travel

Week 14 Easter
M April 6 Easter Break!
W April 8 Swinburne, "Before a Crucifix" (1871); Rossetti, "Monna Innominata" (1881)

Week 15 James
M April 13 James, *In the Cage* (1898)
W April 15 James, *In the Cage* (1898)

Week 16 Sherlocked!
M April 20 Doyle, *The Sign of Four* (1890)
W April 22 Doyle, *The Sign of Four* (1890)

Week 17 Workshop
M April 27 Final Paper Workshop

Reflective Project III Due Sunday, May 3rd, at 11:59PM